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How to schedule 'Do Not Disturb' on devices

- **Automatic Scheduling:** Set Do Not Disturb to activate during specific hours, such as bedtime.
- **Custom Exceptions:** Allow calls from favourites or repeated calls in case of emergencies.

How to create meaningful work-life boundaries

Everyone has to find their way here, there's no one size fits all, but one way to do this right is to establish routines that separate work from personal time.

Avoiding work notifications after hours

- **Email Settings:** Disable push notifications for work emails after hours.
- **Communication Apps:** Mute work-related apps like Slack or Teams when off the clock.

Setting office hours for remote work

- **Calendar Blocks:** Use your calendar to set visible office hours.
- **Communicate Availability:** Inform colleagues of your working hours to set expectations.

How to prioritise digital wellbeing

There's increased science and research that's saying that taking time away from screens benefits mental and physical health.

Benefits of unplugging regularly

- **Reduced Stress:** Less exposure to constant notifications lowers stress levels.
- **Improved Sleep:** Avoiding screens before bed can enhance sleep quality.

Practising mindfulness and reflection

- **Journaling Apps:** Use apps like Day One to reflect on your day.
- **Mindful Moments:** Schedule short breaks to disconnect and breathe.

5) How to avoid digital burnout

Constant connectivity can lead to burnout, affecting your health and productivity. Only you can know your true limit, and you should ensure it's not crossed come what may in 2025 and beyond.

Signs and symptoms of burnout

Recognizing burnout is the first step toward addressing it.

Identifying tech-related fatigue

- **Eye Strain:** Dry eyes or blurred vision after prolonged screen time.
- **Headaches:** Frequent headaches from screen glare or poor posture.

Physical and mental health indicators

- **Insomnia:** Difficulty sleeping due to late-night screen use.
- **Irritability:** Feeling anxious or irritable when away from devices.

How to balance online and offline activities

Diversifying your activities to include non-digital experiences is one of the easiest ways you can do this. Trust me, it helps.

Importance of screen breaks

- **20-20-20 Rule:** Every 20 minutes, look at something 20 feet away for 20 seconds.
- **Regular Movement:** Stand up and stretch to improve circulation.



Engaging in offline hobbies

- **Physical Activities:** Exercise, sports, or yoga to improve health.
- **Creative Pursuits:** Painting, writing, or playing an instrument to stimulate the mind.

Practising self-care with technology

Use technology to support, not hinder, your wellbeing.

Setting personal tech-free goals

- **Digital Detox Days:** Schedule regular days without devices.
- **Bedroom Ban:** Keep devices out of the bedroom to improve sleep.

Mindful use of notifications and alerts

- **Customise Notifications:** Only allow essential alerts.
- **Batch Checking:** Set specific times to check emails and messages.

By embracing responsible tech use, you can enjoy the benefits of technology while maintaining a healthy, balanced lifestyle. Implementing these strategies will not only enhance your productivity but also improve your overall wellbeing as you navigate the digital landscape of 2025. 📖